MULTIMEDIA DESIGN 3

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DUE DATE:	27 October 2026

ASSIGNMENT BRIEF: Academic Research Report

SPECIFICATIONS: This is an individual assignment

Your assignment is to write a 1000-word research report that shows you *know your audience*, the *purpose of your portfolio product*, its *design elements*, and the *information on your website*. The report should talk about how your portfolio fits in with ***current industry standards*** and shows how **research into your chosen field** has **affected the decisions** you made about your **design choices**.

There must be a structured method to your report, and you must use academic references to back up your claims. Make sure you keep a formal, academic tone and follow the Harvard referencing rules as outlined by CPUT.

REQUIREMENTS:

Your academic report must contain the following elements:

1. INTRODUCTION

- Clearly introduce your research topic, providing a brief overview of the project's aim, objectives, and relevance.
- Set the tone for the rest of the report by highlighting how creative technology solutions can address social or industry-specific problems.
- Indicate the focus of your research for your portfolio and its alignment with your employment objectives.

2. BACKGROUND/CONTEXT

- Provide context for your portfolio, explaining its development and positioning within the **creative industry.**
- Discuss the **social or industry challenge** your portfolio addresses, referencing any relevant case studies or existing solutions in the market.
- Outline how your work fits into a **broader industry landscape**, highlighting any **gaps** your work aims to **fill**.

3. MARKET ANALYSIS AND COMPARISON

- Analyse the **existing market for portfolios**, digital products or brands similar to yours. **What** competitors or comparable solutions **currently exist**?
- Discuss how your portfolio **differs from** or **improves upon** these **existing solutions**.
- Explain how your **research into the target audience** and current industry trends **influenced your design decisions**.

4. DISCUSSION OF DESIGN CHOICES AND PORTFOLIO/BRAND RELEVANCE

- Provide an in-depth discussion of the **design and functionality of your portfolio**.
- Relate your **design decisions** to your target audience/industry research, explaining how these **decisions serve your audience** and the **purpose of your product**.
- Draw upon your **previous work or research (strategy documents)** to demonstrate how your portfolio addresses the challenge or problem outlined earlier.
- Critically assess how your portfolio/brand **offers value to its users** and whether it effectively **fills the identified gap** in the market.

5. CONCLUSION

- Summarise the **key points** of your report, reflecting on how your **research and design process** have led to the **development of an effective portfolio**.
- Offer reflections on any **challenges encountered** during the **design and research process**, and how you overcame them.
- Suggest potential areas for **improvement or further research** that could **enhance your portfolio/brand offering**.

6. REFERENCES

- Use at least **five relevant academic references** to support your discussion.
- All references must adhere to the Harvard referencing style and should be listed alphabetically at the end of your report.

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AI USAGE PROTOCOL

- Every student must submit an AI Usage Declaration, even when no generative AI was used.
- Where generative AI was used, include shareable links to, or PDF copies of, the complete and unedited transcripts. Label the evidence clearly and link it to the relevant stage or section of the assessment.
- Include a short critical reflection explaining which tool was used, why it was used, how outputs were checked, and what was changed, rejected or incorporated into the final work.
- You remain responsible for the accuracy, originality, references and design decisions in the submission. AI-generated information must be verified and may not be presented as an academic source.
- Failure to submit the AI Usage Declaration, undeclared or misrepresented AI use and the required supporting evidence will result in an automatic deduction of 15% from the final assessment mark.

SUBMISSION GUIDELINES:

- **Submit a WORD document ONLY.**
- When submitting to Blackboard, do the **SafeAssign submission**, download the **SafeAssign report** and **reupload BOTH** the **SafeAssign report (PDF) and the essay (.DOCX)**.
- Your report must have a cover page with your name and student number on it. The document should be typed, *1.5-line spaced, and submitted on A4 paper using either Calibri or Arial font in 11- or 12- point size*.
- Ensure your report is structured, coherent, and **written in an academic tone**.
- Ensure that you reference using the **CPUT Harvard Method**.

SUBMIT THE CORRECT FILES ONLY. 5% will be deducted if you do not save it properly. NAME YOUR FILE ACCORDINGLY: 5% will be deducted if you do not name it properly. *06_YourName_YourStudentNumber:*

All files MUST be uploaded to Blackboard.

PROGRESS EVALUATION: Students are required to make appointments to speak to their respective lecturers throughout the project.

PLEASE READ THROUGH THE BRIEF PROPERLY: ask questions if you are not sure or do not understand. Check work before handing anything in any missing and non-functional work will result in a deduction of marks.

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RUBRIC FOR ACADEMIC RESEARCH REPORT

CRITERIA	MARKS
INTRODUCTION	
- Sets the tone for the article and introduces the research topic.	/10
- Clearly explains the project's relevance, objectives, and focus.	
BACKGROUND/CONTEXT	
- Provides context to the project, showing relevance to creative industries or social challenges.	/20
- Clearly outlines the problem the portfolio addresses and positions it in the current landscape.	
MARKET ANALYSIS AND COMPARISON	
- Provides a detailed discussion of the market and existing products.	/20
- Clearly articulates how the student's portfolio fills a gap or improves upon existing solutions.	
DISCUSSION OF DESIGN CHOICES AND PRODUCT RELEVANCE	
- Demonstrates the link between design decisions and academic research.	/20
- Provides a critical analysis of how the portfolio addresses the problem and meets its objectives.	
CONCLUSION	
- Reflects on the research and design process, offering insights on successes and challenges.	/10
- Summarises key arguments and provides closing reflections.	
ARGUMENT AND WRITING STYLE	
- Written with clarity, logic, and a structured argument.	/10
- Appropriate tone, minimal grammar or spelling errors.	
REFERENCING	
- Cites at least five relevant academic sources following **CPUT Harvard** referencing.	/10
- Properly formatted and organised references according to **CPUT Harvard** referencing.	
AI USAGE PROTOCOL COMPLIANCE	
- Failure to submit the AI Usage Declaration and required supporting evidence results in an automatic deduction of 15% from the final assessment mark.	-15%
TOTAL	**/100**